

HR Policy Updates -- Effective July 2026

This document summarizes policy changes approved by HR and effective July 1, 2026. These updates supersede the corresponding sections of the existing employee handbook.

1. Wellness Stipend Increase

The annual wellness stipend increases from \$1,000 to \$1,500 per employee, effective July 1, 2026. The stipend can still be used for gym memberships, mental health apps, or fitness equipment, and is reimbursed through the Expense Portal.

2. Hybrid Work Minimum Updated

Hybrid employees are now required in the office a minimum of 3 days per week, up from 2 days per week. Managers will confirm in-office days with their teams by August 1, 2026. Fully remote roles are unaffected by this change.

3. New AI Tools Usage Policy

Employees may use company-approved AI assistants (including internal tools like the HR Assistant) for work tasks. Confidential company data, including unreleased financials or customer PII, must not be pasted into external, non-approved AI tools. Contact security@company.example with questions about whether a specific AI tool is approved.

4. Expense Reimbursement Limit Raised

The monthly internet/phone reimbursement for remote employees increases from \$50 to \$75, effective July 2026. Submit updated receipts through the Expense Portal as usual.

5. New Paid Volunteer Day

Employees now receive 1 additional paid day per year specifically for volunteering with a registered nonprofit of their choice, separate from standard PTO. This does not carry over year to year.

Questions about any of these changes can be directed to hr-policy@company.example.